coursera | MoMA

Modern Art & Ideas ✕

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Modern Art & Ideas

Module 2
Places & Spaces

Introduction to Places & Spaces
- ✓ Welcome to Module 2
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Places & Spaces
  Video • 4 min

Real and Imaginary Places
- ✓ How do artists choose to represent the world?
  Reading • 20 min
- ✓ Martin Wong. Stanton near Forsyth Street. 1983
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Zarina. Home is a Foreign Place. 1999
  Video • 2 min

Experiencing a Place
- ○ **How do artists capture the mood of a place?**
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Claude Monet. Water Lilies. 1914-26
  Video • 1 min
- ○ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ○ Emeka Ogboh. Lagos State of Mind. 2017/2020
  Video • 2 min

Reimagining a Place
- ○ How do artists reimagine architecture?
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Teddy Cruz, Fonna Forman. Manufactured Sites: A Housing Urbanism Made of Waste/Maquiladora, project (Model, 2005). 2005-2008
  Video • 2 min
- ○ Carolina Caycedo. Spirals for Shared Dreams. 2022
  Video • 4 min

Review & Reflect
- ○ Optional Readings & Resources
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Assessment: Places & Spaces
  Dialogue • 15 min
- ○ Optional Prompts for Discussion & Reflection
  Reading • 10 min

Module 3
Art & Identity

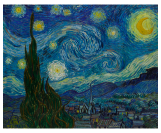
Module 4
Transforming Everyday Objects

Module 5
Module 5: Art & Society

Module 6
Course Conclusion

How do artists capture the mood of a place?

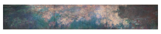
0:05 / 4:38 1x



Vincent van Gogh. *The Starry Night*. 1889. Oil on canvas, 29 x 36 1/4" (73.7 x 92.1 cm). Acquired through the Lillie P. Bliss Bequest

"This morning I saw the countryside from my window a long time before sunrise, with nothing but the morning star, which looked very big," wrote Vincent van Gogh to his brother Theo, describing his inspiration for *The Starry Night*. The window to which he refers was in the Saint-Paul asylum in Saint-Rémy, in southern France, where the artist spent twelve months in 1889–90 seeking reprieve from his mental illnesses, while continuing to make art.

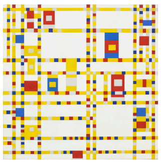
The Starry Night is based on van Gogh's direct observations as well as his imagination, memories, and emotions. The steeple of the church, for example, resembles those common in his native Holland, not in France. The whirling forms in the sky, on the other hand, match published astronomical observations of clouds of dust and gas known as nebulae. At once balanced and expressive, the composition is structured by his ordered placement of the cypress, steeple, and central nebulae, while his countless short brushstrokes and thickly applied paint set its surface in rolling motion. Such a combination of visual contrasts was generated by an artist who found beauty and interest in the night, which, for him, was "much more alive and richly colored than the day."



Claude Monet. *Water Lilies*. 1914–26. Oil on canvas, three panels, Each 6' 3/4" x 41' 10 3/8" (200 x 1276 cm). Mrs. Simon Guggenheim Fund

In the final decades of his life, Claude Monet embarked on making a series of monumental paintings depicting the lush lily ponds in his gardens in Giverny, in northwestern France. His elaborate garden required six full-time gardeners to maintain.

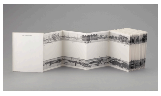
In these paintings, he aimed to convey the sensation of water without end. He filled his canvases from edge-to-edge with layered color and brushstrokes, capturing his perception of the water lilies, the play of sunlight and shadow, and the reflections of the sky, clouds, and garden surroundings on the pond's ever-changing surface.



Piet Mondrian. *Broadway Boogie Woogie*. 1942–43. Oil on canvas, 50 x 50" (127 x 127 cm). Given anonymously

Piet Mondrian arrived in New York in 1940, one of the many European artists who moved to the United States to escape World War II. He immediately fell in love with the city and with boogie-woogie music, to which he was introduced on his first night in New York. One of the leaders of de Stijl, a form of abstraction that renounced naturalistic representation in favor of straight lines, rectangular planes, and primary colors (red, blue, and yellow) meant to create visual harmony and restore order and balance to everyday life.

Broadway Boogie Woogie breaks Mondrian's signature bars of color into multicolored segments. Bouncing against each other, these tiny, blinking blocks of color create a vital and pulsing rhythm, an optical vibration that jumps from intersection to intersection like traffic on the streets of New York. At the same time, the painting is carefully calibrated, its colors interspersed with gray and white blocks.



Edward Ruscha. *Every Building on the Sunset Strip*. 1966. Artist's book, offset printed. Page (each): 7 × 5 1/2" (17.8 × 14 cm); overall (closed): 7 1/8 × 5 5/8 × 7/16" (18.1 × 14.3 × 1.1 cm). Publisher: Edward Ruscha. Printer: Dick de Ruscha, Los Angeles. Edition: 1,000. Partial gift of the Daled Collection and partial purchase through the generosity of Maja Oeri and Hans Bodenmann, Sue and Edgar Wachenheim III, Agnes Gund, Marlene Hess and James D. Zirin, Marie-Josée and Henry R. Kravis, and Jerry I. Speyer and Katherine G. Farley © 2024 Edward Ruscha

Unfolding to nearly twenty-five feet, or seven and a half meters, this accordion-format book includes a photocollage that captures both sides of over a mile of the 22-mile Sunset Boulevard in Los Angeles. To achieve this continuous image, Ed Ruscha and a team mounted a motorized camera on the bed of his pickup truck. He tried to convey in his book the flat, horizontal nature of Los Angeles—a city so often experienced by driving. Ruscha has said about his approach to this project, "It's just like copying something for what it is."

Mark as completed

Like Dislike Report an issue

Go to next item →